

- NOT THEORETICAL

This wasn't a "maybe" vulnerability. It was already being used.

Four days after WordPress patched wp2shell, the US government confirmed active attacks.

02/07

THE CONFIRMATION

CISA added wp2shell to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog.

That list only includes bugs confirmed to be in use against real targets — not theoretical risks.

03/07

WHY IT MATTERS

"Overblown" wasn't on the table.

A site sitting on WordPress 6.8–7.0.1 through mid-to-late July wasn't a maintenance item for later. It was a door left open while people were trying the handle.

THE RESPONSE

WordPress force-pushed the fix.

Auto-update rolled it out automatically, rather than waiting on site owners to click "update" themselves. That almost never happens.

05/07

THE CATCH

If your auto-updates are off, the fix may never have reached you.

The emergency patch didn't apply itself everywhere.
Some sites are still waiting on a manual update, right now.

Two-minute check:

- 01 Log into wp-admin and check Dashboard › Updates
- 02 Confirm your version is 6.8.6, 6.9.5, 7.0.2 or later
- 03 If auto-updates are off, update manually today — not on your next maintenance pass

• TALKTOWP

A stale version shouldn't depend on memory.

TalktoWP catches a WordPress version falling behind before an attacker finds it — no manual checking required.

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